

THE GLAMSQUAD SALON

END-TO-END Project Report

Profitability & Operational Analytics | Business Analysis + Data Analysis

Project Summary	Details
Client	The GlamSquad Salon
Engagement	Direct contact
Period	May-Aug 2025
Role	Business Analyst + Data Analyst
Primary Stakeholder	Salon manager
Business Problem	Declining profitability
Data History	Approximately one year
Sources	Excel and handwritten operational records; qualitative feedback from multiple channels
Tools	Excel, Google Sheets, SQL, Python and Power BI
Confirmed Outcome	15% profit increase within approximately two months
Confidentiality: Underlying client financial values, service prices, margins, salaries/commissions, customer information and other sensitive commercial details are not disclosed.	
Portfolio status: This report reconstructs the project in a professional case-study format. Exact historical schema, code, dashboard layout, test logs and formal approvals are not presented as facts where they are not retained.	

1. Executive Summary

The GlamSquad Salon engagement focused on diagnosing declining profitability and translating the analysis into practical commercial and operational actions. The work combined business analysis with data analysis: understanding the manager's problem, consolidating unclean records, defining relevant KPIs, analyzing profitability drivers, identifying root causes, building a Power BI dashboard from scratch, presenting findings, and supporting recommendations.

The diagnostic work showed that profitability pressure was multi-factor rather than attributable to one isolated issue. Confirmed findings included insufficient staff during peak periods, underutilized staff at other times, material differences in revenue generated by stylists, salary/commission cost pressure, scheduling problems, pricing and discount concerns, differences in service economics, meaningful cancellations/no-shows, and customer-experience themes.

Business result: Necessary recommendations were implemented across relevant areas, and profit increased by 15% within approximately two months.

2. End-to-End Project Story

Project flow: Declining profitability -> requirements/data discovery -> messy-data preparation -> profitability decomposition -> staffing/pricing/customer/service analysis -> qualitative feedback analysis -> root-cause diagnosis -> Power BI reporting -> recommendations -> implementation -> 15% profit improvement.

The project is best positioned as a profitability and operational optimization case study, not simply as a dashboard project. The dashboard was the decision-support layer built on top of requirements, data preparation, diagnostic analysis and root-cause reasoning.

3. Role & Responsibilities

Business Analysis Responsibilities	Data Analysis Responsibilities
Understand the manager's business problem and reporting needs.	Profile and prepare unclean Excel/handwritten data.
Translate the problem into analytical questions and requirements.	Analyze revenue, expenses and profitability drivers.
Structure findings using root-cause analysis.	Analyze appointments, cancellations/no-shows and demand patterns.
Connect findings to actionable recommendations.	Analyze services, pricing, discounts and service economics.
Present the solution through a live walkthrough.	Analyze staff/stylist activity, revenue, utilization and costs.
Maintain confidentiality and defensible evidence boundaries.	Analyze repeat customers/retention and qualitative feedback; build Power BI reporting.

4. Business Problem & Objectives

The manager needed to understand why profitability was declining and what changes could improve business performance. The analysis therefore had to move beyond total revenue and investigate the underlying operational and commercial drivers.

Objective	Business Question
Profitability visibility	What is happening to revenue, expenses and profit?
Driver diagnosis	Which revenue-side and cost/operational factors are affecting profit?
Appointment optimization	Are cancellations, no-shows or utilization creating lost opportunity?
Customer continuity	Are customers returning, and what does retention/repeat behaviour show?
Service economics	Which services, prices, discounts and costs require attention?
Staffing optimization	Is staff capacity aligned with demand and commercial output?
Customer experience	Do feedback themes reinforce issues visible in the data?
Actionability	Which changes should management implement and monitor?

5. Scope

In Scope	Evidence / Analysis
Profitability	Revenue, expenses, profit and profitability drivers
Appointments	Bookings, utilization, cancellations and no-shows
Customers	Customer data, repeat visits and retention analysis
Services	Services performed, service prices, service mix and revenue by service
Staff	Stylist/staff data, working hours, attendance, revenue/activity and utilization context
Costs	Salaries/commissions, product/material costs and expenses
Commercial actions	Pricing, discounts, promotions and service-mix considerations
Feedback	Google reviews, Instagram comments, WhatsApp feedback, surveys, salon records and direct conversations
Reporting	Power BI dashboard built from scratch and live walkthrough

6. Explicit Evidence Boundaries

- Exact customer, appointment, staff and row counts are not retained.
- Exact revenue/profit rupee values, service prices, margins, discount rates and commission percentages are confidential or not retained.
- Exact peak hours/days are not retained; the remembered pattern is generally evenings and major-festival periods.
- Exact historical SQL, Python, Power Query and DAX implementations are not claimed.
- Exact original table/column names and Power BI relationships are not retained.
- Formal UAT sign-off, defect counts and production deployment architecture are not claimed.

7. Data Landscape

Data Domain	Confirmed Content
Appointments	Appointments/bookings, cancellations and no-shows
Services	Services performed and service prices
Customers	Customer information and repeat visits
Staff	Staff/stylist data, working hours and attendance
Compensation	Salaries and commissions
Costs	Product/material costs and other expenses
Commercial	Revenue and discounts
Feedback	Multiple public, private and direct feedback channels
Source condition: The operational data was not clean and was distributed across Excel and handwritten records.	

8. Data Preparation Methodology

The portfolio reconstruction uses a controlled preparation workflow that reflects the confirmed source context without inventing exact historical issue counts.

Stage	Method
Source inventory	Identify source purpose, grain, period coverage and confidentiality.
Digitization	Convert readable handwritten records into structured tabular form; flag unclear values rather than guessing.
Profiling	Check completeness, duplicates, formats, ranges, category consistency and referential integrity.
Standardization	Normalize dates, service names, staff labels, appointment statuses and numeric fields.
Customer matching	Use phone-number data in a protected layer to identify repeat visits; expose only sanitized keys publicly.
Commercial validation	Validate revenue, discounts, expenses, salary/commission and material-cost values.
Derived fields	Create documented analytical fields only where business rules are defensible.
Reconciliation	Compare prepared totals and categories before loading the reporting model.

9. Logical Portfolio Data Model

Entity	Purpose
Customers	Sanitized customer identity for repeat/retention analysis
Appointments	Core appointment/service activity and status
Services	Standardized service attributes
Staff	Sanitized staff/stylist attributes
Staff Working Hours	Working-time/capacity context where available
Expenses	Expense/cost fact
Feedback	Sanitized qualitative evidence

Date

Calendar/time reporting

Model status: This is a recommended logical rebuild. It is not presented as the exact historical client schema.

10. KPI Framework

KPI Area	Measures / Concepts
Profitability	Revenue, Expenses, Profit, Profit Margin %, Profit Improvement %
Appointments	Total/Completed Appointments, Appointment Utilization %, Cancellation Rate %, No-Show Rate %
Customers	Unique Customers, Repeat Customers, Repeat Customer Rate %, Retention where a rule is defined
Services	Revenue by Service, Service Mix %, Average Revenue per Completed Appointment, Discount measures, Service Contribution/Margin where valid
Staff	Revenue by Stylist, Appointments by Stylist, Revenue per Working Hour, Staff Utilization % where valid, Commission indicators
Costs	Material Cost % where attribution is defensible
Operations / Feedback	Peak-demand pattern and feedback-theme analysis
Core formula: Profit = Revenue - Expenses.	
Outcome formula: Profit Improvement % = (Profit After Recommendations - Profit Before Recommendations) / Profit Before Recommendations x 100.	

11. Profitability Decomposition

Revenue / Customer Drivers	Cost / Operational Drivers
Service mix	Salary and commission costs
Pricing	Staff underutilization
Discounts	Peak-period understaffing
Completed appointments	Scheduling inefficiency
Cancellations / no-shows	Product/material costs
Repeat customers / retention	Cost relative to productive output
Customer experience / availability	Operational capacity alignment

This decomposition prevented the analysis from assuming that higher sales alone would solve the problem. Profitability was treated as the combined effect of realized revenue, service economics, operating costs and capacity efficiency.

12. Root Cause Analysis

Root-Cause Area	Confirmed Finding	Profitability Link
Staffing alignment	Insufficient staff during peak periods and underutilization elsewhere.	Can constrain revenue opportunity while carrying inefficient labour capacity.
Scheduling	Scheduling problems were identified.	Creates demand-capacity mismatch.
Stylist performance	Major differences in revenue by stylist.	Requires investigation of workload, service mix, hours and customer context.
Staff costs	Salary/commission costs were significant to the diagnosis.	Raises cost pressure relative to productive output.
Pricing	Some services were identified as potentially underpriced.	Can weaken service economics.
Discounting	Discounts were too high in relevant cases.	Can reduce realized revenue.
Service economics	Premium services showed stronger margin/economic characteristics.	Service mix affects commercial contribution.
Cancellations/no-shows	Meaningful operational problem.	Booked capacity may not convert into completed service.
Repeat behaviour	Repeat customers and retention were analyzed.	Recurring visits support sustainable demand.
Customer experience	Pricing, staff behaviour, cleanliness and staff availability were confirmed themes.	Adds customer context to operational/commercial findings.

13. Staffing & Scheduling Diagnosis

A key operational finding was the coexistence of peak-period understaffing and underutilized staff at other times. This indicates an allocation/scheduling issue rather than a simple headcount problem.

Demand pattern: The remembered pattern was stronger demand generally during evenings and around major festival periods; exact historical hours, days and festival names are not retained.

Staff performance was not interpreted using revenue alone. Revenue by stylist was considered alongside activity, working hours/utilization, repeat-customer context, feedback where attributable, and salary/commission cost considerations.

14. Pricing, Discounts & Service Economics

The analysis considered whether some services were underpriced, whether discounting was excessive, and how service mix and direct costs affected commercial contribution. Premium services were remembered as having stronger margin/economic characteristics.

Control: Service-level contribution/margin should only be calculated where direct costs can be reliably attributed; exact historical cost-allocation methodology is not claimed.

15. Customer & Appointment Analysis

Appointment analysis covered utilization, demand patterns, cancellations and no-shows. Cancellations/no-shows were confirmed as a meaningful business problem because reserved capacity may remain unproductive when an appointment is lost.

Repeat customers were identified using phone-number data. For the public portfolio, that logic should be represented through sanitized customer keys rather than exposing phone numbers.

Retention boundary: Retention was analyzed, but the exact historical retention window/rule is not retained. A sanitized rebuild must define the rule explicitly before calculating a retention percentage.

16. Customer Feedback Analysis

Confirmed Source	Use in Analysis
Google reviews	Public customer-experience context
Instagram comments	Social feedback context
WhatsApp feedback	Direct/private feedback, requiring sanitization
Surveys	Structured/semi-structured feedback
Salon records	Internal feedback context
Direct conversations	Verbal customer context
Confirmed Theme	Analytical Connection
Pricing	Compared with pricing/service-economics decisions
Staff behaviour	Added service-quality context to staff analysis
Cleanliness	Highlighted an operational/customer-experience concern
Staff availability	Reinforced investigation of staffing and scheduling alignment
Triangulation: Qualitative feedback was used to strengthen or challenge quantitative interpretation, not to create fabricated sentiment percentages or financial causation.	

17. Power BI Solution

A Power BI dashboard was built from scratch and used as the management reporting layer. The exact historical PBIX page names and visual arrangement are not retained; the portfolio reconstruction organizes the solution into four logical views.

Logical Dashboard View	Decision Support
Executive Profitability Overview	Revenue, expenses, profit and major business drivers
Service & Pricing Analysis	Service mix, revenue, pricing, discounts and service economics
Staff Performance & Utilization	Stylist activity/revenue, working hours, utilization and staffing alignment
Customer & Appointment Analysis	Appointments, cancellations/no-shows, repeat customers, retention and demand patterns

The dashboard should be described as a decision-support output built on the analysis, not as the entirety of the project.

18. Data Model & DAX Positioning

For the portfolio, the model and DAX library are documented as a logical reconstruction. This enables a reproducible technical demonstration while preserving interview credibility.

Confirmed	Reconstructed / Portfolio Specification
Power BI was used and the dashboard was built from scratch.	Exact table/field names and star-schema design
Profitability, appointment, service, customer and staff analysis were performed.	Exact DAX syntax and measure names
Profit logic and 15% improvement are defensible at the business level.	Exact Power Query transformations and PBIX relationships
The dashboard supported a live walkthrough.	Exact page layout, visual theme, refresh/deployment configuration

19. Dashboard Design Principle

Design rule: Every page should answer a management question: headline KPI -> trend/comparison -> diagnostic breakdown -> actionable insight.

- Use consistent KPI definitions across pages.
- Use filters only where they support the decision question.
- Do not expose confidential client values or customer PII.
- Suppress conditional metrics when their prerequisites are not defensible.
- Keep qualitative feedback visually separate from financial transaction metrics.

20. Findings & Recommendations

Finding	Recommendation Direction
Peak-period understaffing / off-peak underutilization	Align staffing more closely with demand patterns.
Scheduling problems	Use appointment-demand patterns to improve roster decisions.
Stylist revenue variation	Use balanced staff-performance analysis rather than revenue-only ranking.
Salary/commission pressure	Review staff-linked costs alongside productive output.
Potential underpricing	Adjust pricing where service economics support change.
Excessive discounts	Strengthen discount control and use targeted offers.
Service economics variation	Optimize service mix and promote commercially stronger services appropriately.
Cancellations/no-shows	Reduce avoidable appointment loss through operational actions.
Repeat-customer opportunity	Use repeat-customer initiatives and targeted promotions.
Cost pressure	Reduce avoidable operating/material/staff-linked costs without damaging service quality.
Customer feedback issues	Address pricing perception, staff behaviour, cleanliness and availability as appropriate.

21. Recommendation Monitoring

Action Category	KPIs / Evidence
Pricing	Revenue by Service, Average Revenue per Completed Appointment, Service Contribution/Margin where valid
Discount control	Discount Amount/Rate, Revenue, service economics
Staffing / scheduling	Appointments, demand pattern, Staff Utilization %, Revenue per Working Hour
Service mix	Revenue by Service, Service Mix %, contribution where valid
Cancellation/no-show actions	Cancellation Rate %, No-Show Rate %, Completed Appointments
Repeat-customer initiatives	Repeat Customers, Repeat Customer Rate %, retention where defined
Cost reduction	Expenses, Profit, Profit Margin %, relevant staff/material cost indicators
Customer experience	Feedback themes plus repeat/appointment context

22. Implementation & Outcome

The user confirmed that necessary recommendations across relevant commercial and operational areas were implemented. Because multiple interventions were made, the result should be attributed to the combined improvement program rather than to any single action.

Confirmed result: Profit increased by 15% within approximately two months.

The underlying before/after rupee values remain confidential, and no percentage contribution is assigned to individual interventions.

23. Data Validation & Dashboard Testing

The portfolio testing approach validates the analytical product from source to visual output. Exact historical test logs or formal UAT records are not retained.

Testing Layer	Key Controls
Source / transcription	Review digitized handwritten records, dates, completeness and ambiguous values
Customer	Phone-based repeat matching, deduplication and PII masking
Appointments	Status mapping, completed/cancelled/no-show reconciliation and denominator rules
Services	Service mapping, revenue reconciliation, discount semantics and conditional margin logic
Staff	Staff mapping, attributed revenue/activity, working hours and utilization prerequisites
Financial	Revenue, expenses, profit, margin and before/after consistency
Model / DAX	Key uniqueness, relationships, filter propagation and independent KPI checks
Dashboard	Filters, cross-highlighting, cross-page consistency, blank/zero behaviour and labels
Privacy	No customer PII or original confidential client values in public outputs

24. Acceptance Boundary

Confirmed: A live walkthrough was performed with the manager.

Not claimed: Formal signed UAT approval, defect counts, pass-rate metrics, production release sign-off, Row-Level Security or deployment architecture are not supported by retained evidence.

25. Confidentiality & Portfolio Sanitization

Sensitive Area	Portfolio Treatment
Customer phone numbers / identities	Remove or replace with sanitized keys
Staff identities	Use sanitized labels where appropriate
Revenue / profit / expense values	Use sanitized demonstration values; retain only the confirmed 15% outcome
Salary / commission values	Do not publish original values
Service prices / margins	Do not publish original confidential values
Private feedback	Redact/paraphrase; do not publish identifiable messages
Exact client schema/code	Rebuild logically and label as reconstruction

26. Requirements-to-Outcome Traceability

Business Need	Analysis / Solution	Action	Outcome Link
Understand profitability	Revenue/expense/profit decomposition and executive dashboard	Combined commercial and operational actions	Supports measured profit improvement
Improve appointment economics	Cancellation/no-show and demand analysis	Appointment-loss reduction and scheduling actions	Improves conversion of capacity into service activity
Improve staffing efficiency	Staff revenue/activity/utilization analysis	Demand-aligned staffing and scheduling	Supports cost/output alignment
Improve service economics	Service/pricing/discount analysis	Pricing, discount and service-mix actions	Supports stronger realized economics
Strengthen recurring demand	Repeat/retention analysis	Repeat-customer initiatives/promotions	Supports customer continuity
Improve customer experience	Feedback-theme analysis	Operational/customer-experience actions	Supports service quality and retention context

27. BA Deliverables Demonstrated

Deliverable	Portfolio Evidence
Project Overview / Business Problem	Business context, scope, objectives and evidence boundaries
BRD	Business requirements for profitability, appointments, customers, services, staff, costs, feedback and dashboard
User Stories & Acceptance Criteria	Manager-centered analytical/reporting stories with testable criteria
KPI Catalogue	Business definitions and calculation intent
Data Dictionary	Logical sanitized schema
Data Cleaning Methodology	Source-to-analysis preparation controls
Root Cause Analysis	Profitability problem tree and evidence synthesis
Customer Feedback Analysis	Qualitative-quantitative triangulation
Power BI Requirements	Decision-support and reporting specification
Data Model & DAX	Reproducible technical rebuild
Findings & Recommendations	Finding-to-action traceability
Testing	Data, KPI, model, dashboard and privacy validation

28. Skills Demonstrated

Business Analysis	Data / BI Analysis
Requirements discovery and problem framing	Data profiling, cleaning and preparation
Business process / root-cause thinking	SQL/Python analytical workflow
KPI definition and traceability	Profitability and operational analysis
Stakeholder communication	Customer/service/staff segmentation
Recommendation development	Power BI data modelling and measures
Acceptance/testing thinking	Dashboard validation and reconciliation
Confidentiality/evidence discipline	Qualitative + quantitative triangulation

29. STAR Narrative

STAR	Defensible Story
Situation	The GlamSquad Salon was experiencing declining profitability and had approximately one year of unclear operational information across Excel and handwritten records.
Task	Identify the commercial and operational causes, build decision-support reporting, and recommend practical improvements.
Action	Gathered requirements with the manager; prepared the data; analyzed profitability, appointments, services, pricing/discounts, customers, staff, costs and feedback; performed root-cause analysis; built a Power BI dashboard from scratch; and presented findings/recommendations in a live walkthrough.
Result	Necessary recommendations were implemented across relevant areas, and profit increased by 15% within approximately two months.

By: Chinmayee Surwade

Email: chinmayee.surwade@gmail.com